Examining the Social Category “Queer” in the Chinese Context

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1. Introduction: Queer in Chinese Context

Modern individuals usually adopt and apply multi-dimensional identities in everyday practices. Identity is a mixed product of an individual's internal subjectivity and external social category system (Staunæs 2003; Ásta 2018). No matter whether people believe their identities are socially imposed or they proactively embrace, the social category system is always relatively independent, existing intermediately between individuals and social structure. Its relationship with individuals and social structure is interactive: individuals and society can use and impact social categories, whereas social categories can reflect and represent individuals and society.

This study begins with an interest in capturing these ambiguous and fluid social categories, and I pay specific attention to the gender and sexuality category. Gender and sexuality category has become a more and more important dimension in modern individuals' subjectivity and social life. Among these labels, "queer" is one of the most popular but also most tricky categories that emerged after the 1990s. On one hand, queer theorists and activists emphasize that "queer" should be a term without definition: it is designed to challenge normativity and "fixed" boundaries; On the other hand, "queer" has rapidly extended to become a global identity or cultural phenomenon that goes far beyond its original Western-English context. For example, "queer" also entered China in the dramatic 1990s. Contemporary terminologists generally trace its Chinese beginning back to the Fourth World Conference on Women held in Beijing in 1995, or Chinese sociologist Li Yinhe's translation collection *Queer Theory* (2003) (Zhao and Wong 2020). English and Chinese are two very different languages, just as the United States also shares a disparate social environment with the socialist Chinese society. But the word "queer" has now become familiar to many young Chinese people and has been used in their Chinese context. Even more controversial, "queer", compared to many other imported Western concepts or categories, has never received a formal translation after entering the Chinese context. When the word "homosexual" become "same sex love"[同性恋], "lesbian" becomes "female same sex love" [女同性恋] or "transgender" becomes "cross gender"[跨性别], "queer" is always used either in its original English form "queer", or in an informal Chinese transliteration "ku'er" [酷儿] (which without any other Chinese semantic meaning). This unique case also grants me a further curiosity about why and how Chinese people use the "queer" today.

When the word "queer" spreads into non-Western cultures and regions, many cultures encounter a similar linguistic duplication and transliteration, which has stimulated some kinds of anxiety among post-colonialist scholars who concern it may suggest an implicit universalization of Western gender culture, and be harmful to the diverse local culture and gender categories (Wilson 2006; Sinnott 2010; Dutta and Roy 2014; Savci 2020; Gonsalves 2025). Although just as Wilson (2006) have early suggested that cross-cultural usage of Western category does not necessarily mean a universalization or homogenization of Western culture, relatively few scholars have formally addressed this linguistic issue beyond a political critique, since semantic meaning is generally seen as hard to capture or measure. That's where this study want to further the academic discussion by introducing the contemporary Natural Language Processing (NLP) techniques, which may offer a new set of tools to help scholars examine sematic meanings in cross-cultural usage.

Therefore, this study intends to explore the semantic meaning of "queer" in the contemporary Chinese context by employing the NLP techniques. I may shed light on the two research questions: How is the social category "queer" socially defined and presented in the Chinese context? How do modern Chinese individuals use the word "queer" in their online discussions?

2. Literature Review: Employing NLP into Cultural Analysis

In the past decade, employing modern Natural Language Processing (NLP) techniques into cultural analysis has become a vibrant new trend in social science and humanities. NLP includes a large number of different approaches and models, and is now seen as be able to help researchers deal with the textual data that were hard to quantify, and also explore the latent cultural meaning (e.g., Kulkarni 2015 et al.; Kozlowski et al. 2019; Jiang 2025).

However, using NLP techniques or the broader quantitative techniques in cultural analysis has constantly been controversial. From the technical perspective, many scholars have emphasized the uncertainty to deal with the language and textual data since they cannot be easily measured by human, let alone machine. For example, Ehrmann et al. (2023) suggest that historical texts are hard to collect and clean, and language and variation of cultural entities are never homogenous, fixed, and "finite" like some NLP technicians may suppose. When shifting from the long historical text to short modern texts such as the posts on social media, NLP may also be challenged by lacking of contextual information and also impacted by the "noisy" symbols, emojis, typos, abbreviation and spellings (Albalawi et al. 2020). In addition to these technical challenges, there is also a long-term philosophical debate on whether the NLP technique or language model could really understand and "learn" culture or not (e.g., Bode 2020; Grindrod 2026). Quantitative approach in humanities is also often critiqued as continuing to be biased, neglecting implicit political, critical and ethical issues, and essentializing/generalizing the "culture" concept (Bode 2020). But what Bode (2020) actually wants to emphasize is not to take an "either-or" choice between the qualitative and quantitative approach, but rather an advocacy for their coexistence and mutual enhancement. Although NLP may not be a neutral and perfect instrument, it is neither "useless" nor "meaningless" (Bode 2020; Grindrod 2026). Instead of viewing language models as directly measure or exhibit the real world, Grindrod (2026) suggests that it is possible to consider them as the latent or proxy linguistic structures and help scholars to gain insights. In other words, the usage of NLP could be seen as an attempt to reconstruct social life through linguistic structure.

Nowadays, many studies have attempted to employ NLP techniques into cultural analysis. These studies are generally based on a basic assumption that language can literally reflect cultural meaning, and semantic meaning changes can reflect the change of cultural or social meaning, as well as the society per se. For example, Kulkarni et al. (2015) use the word frequency, co-occurrences, and syntactic time series to detect the semantic shifts of some English words, such as "gay" or "bitch", as a way to connect with the important social events in the 20th century. In recent years, word embedding models have become one of the most popular models to analyze diachronic semantic shifts. Kozlowski et al. (2019), Best and Arseniev-Koehler (2023), and Jiang (2025) have all employed similar methods, using Word2Vec to embed word vectors from extensive textual corpora (such as the Google Ngram) or publications (such as newspapers and magazines) to analyze specific cultural phenomena or concepts, such as "class", "occupation", or "stigma". Word2Vec model has a great capacity to trace diachronic semantic shifts, but as a static embedding, it has limited ability to capture the synchronic semantic diversity. That's where contextual embeddings, such as BERT model and pretraining language models, become necessary.

Many current contextual embedding model relies on pretraining, which has been "notorious" almost the moment they appear. Many scholars have examined the limitations of pre-trained models, such as biases and inequalities in their training datasets (e.g., BERT was trained on Wikipedia and the BookCorpus) or the difficulty of scaling or modifying them after training is complete (Lewis et al., 2020; Arora et al., 2023). Even though many scholars have committed to developing pretraining

language models and fine-tuning techniques (e.g., Gururangan et al. 2020; Lewis et al, 2020), these have also given future scholars many challenges and uncertainties. Any scholars using the contextual embedding model need to be more cautious of their language processing.

Overall, in contrast to continue the former attempt to use static word embedding models to deal with the diachronic semantic meaning, this study intends to explore the possibility of employing contextual embedding models to explore the synchronic semantic diversity.

3. Data and Method

This study draws on contextual word embedding models to explore the semantic diversity of the word "queer" in the Chinese context.

To understand how the word "queer" is used in the real Chinese everyday discussion and capture its diverse possibilities, this study collects textual data from the Chinese social media RedNote. RedNote is an open-access Chinese-language social platform where users are allowed to freely share their threads and respond to others. I identify the word "queer" as my conceptual keyword and mixed to treat both its English original form and Chinese transliterations as the keyword input (see Table 1). In the following text, each time I refer to the word "queer" without specifically pointing out its English form, I mean it and all its variants in both English and Chinese language forms.

Table 1: Conceptual Keywords on the RedNote Analysis

English Meaning of the Keywords	Keywords Input
Queer	"Queer", "Queers", "酷儿[ku'er]"[1]

Through searching the keywords "queer" on RedNote's own search engine and then collect all the results it generated, I eventually collected 460 valid posts. Then I transform the title and main content of each post into one complete text. Although comments are also valuable data, I did not include them since they are often mixed-authored and overly fragmented.

It is important to clarify that the data from RedNote may not be as ideal as it is supposed to be. Due to its platform policies, I cannot access to its API to request data directly, but only search the keywords through its search engine and then collect the relevant posts results (up to 1,000 posts), it automatically respond. RedNote's algorithm companies randomness: whenever I slightly change the keywords or search the same thing repeatedly, searching results maybe always somewhat different. These restrictions cause that it is nearly impossible to trace the diachronic semantic changes and the data I collected from the search result only represent one random selections at a specific time period. However, I still use RedNote as my dataset because it remains the most widely used Chinese social media platform in the specific Chinese context. Furthermore, the algorithmic barrier is not unique to RedNote but is increasingly prevalent on various social media platforms, posing a similar challenge for all researchers. There does not exist an alternative database that is more suited, accessible, and reliable simultaneously. If general users search and review the similar posts results like what I found, even if the data is incomplete, I think I still have a reason to believe this data represent at least one side of the

1 "酷儿[ku'er]" is a Chinese term without original Chinese meaning. But it has been used to serve as the transliteration of two English terms, "queer" and "Qoo". Qoo is the name of a beverage from the Coca-Cola Company. During the data collection, I manually read, checked and then deleted the data that is obviously related to the "Qoo" beverage. I once considered to include "Qoo" into analysis, but later I decided to focus on exactly the gender and sexuality category "queer" and treat "Qoo" as noise.

social usage of the word "queer" in the 2020s. In short, it is necessary to regard the data within this study as reflecting a possibility, rather than a comprehensive picture, of the cultural meaning of the word "queer".

To analyze the semantic meaning of the word "queer", I employ the contextual embedding model including the Name Entity Recognition (NER) and BERT language model. I first identified the key entities and co-occurrence between "queer" and key entities to explore its related contextual information. Then, I analyze its contextual variation through clustering the meaning groups by the BERT models, and finally use supervised classification (logistic regression) to examine the clustering results. Also because my texts are mixed Chinese and English, I use Chinese spaCy and load the specific Chinese tokenizer "Jieba" and Chinese stop words list "Baidu" when processing my text[2].

4. Findings: Reading "Queer" in the Chinese Context

Data Exploration

Across 460 valid posts, there are 111,283 raw tokens and 14,592 unique tokens. The top 10 tokens after cleaning suggest these posts potentially have a primarily high relevance to the gender, academic, cultural and identity topics (see Table 2).

Table 2: Top 10 tokens after cleaning

Raw tokens after cleaning	Raw Counts
Queer [酷儿][3]	854
Gender [性别]	600
Women [女性]	454
Research [研究]	282
Culture [文化]	264
Identity [身份]	258
Society [社会]	256
Movie [电影]	224
Identification [认同]	215
Relationship [关系]	200

Social media posts are generally shorter than regular text. RedNote post is max to 1,000 characters while many users chose to write even shorter, which cause a larger window in my corpus may not provide a richer context but more noisy and irrelevant information. Also since Barberá et al. (2021) found that using longer segmented and shorter sentence as the unit of analysis may perform similar results, I decide to define each sentence that exactly incudes the conceptual keyword "queer" as my unit of analysis.

By using sentence as the unit of analysis, the word "queer" and its variants have occurred 864 times while the top 5 high occurrences appeared in text number 37, text 176, text 95, text 110 and text

2 Learning more details about "Jieba": https://github.com/fxsjy/jieba; or the Baidu stop word list: https://github.com/goto456/stopwords/blob/master/baidu_stopwords.txt

3 Language is significant in this study and I pay close attention to these same word but are used in different languages. In later sections I will explain why. Because I use mixed-language tokenizer and produce the results bilingually. In this essay, if a English term follows a Chinese translation (such as "relationship"[关系]), it means this key term is originally identified in its Chinese form. Otherwise, a single English term, like "queer", means it is identified directly in its English form.

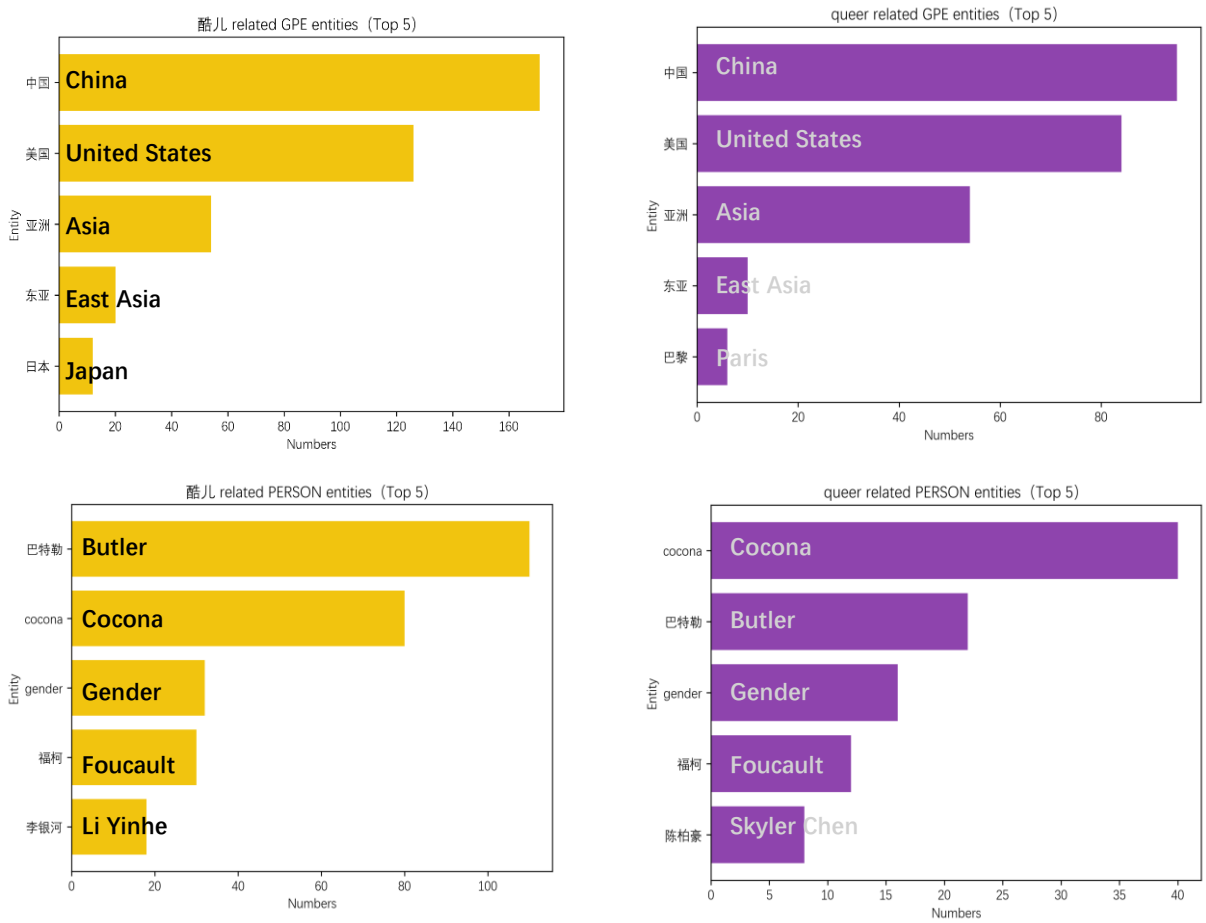
222. These random social media posts cannot reflect the semantic variety. In order to further understand the initial pattern of "queer" within these posts, it is necessary to investigate the co-occurrence between sentences and keywords beyond its occurrence across texts.

Named Entity Recognition

Named Entity Recognition (NER) is able to identify the key entities such as person, location, geography, organization across the texts. I first train my own vectorizer and classifier (using Word2Vec to generate labels and tiers) to generate a high confident subset for the keyword "queer", and then imported the pre-trained Chinese spaCy model to conduct the NER task. To answer the research questions, I specifically focus on the key person and geographical location that are related to the producing of this transnational category "queer".

According to the results in Plot 1, the Chinese "ku'er"[酷儿] and English "queer" have suggested similar but also slightly different results. Both Chinese and English "queer" are closely intertwined with the geographical location China, the United States, Asia, and East Asia, while at the same time showcasing an intimate tie with the key figure such as Western queer theorist Judith Butler, philosopher Michel Foucault, and the recent popular Japanese queer idol Cocona. Interestingly, the different language forms of "queer" also appear to have different relevance to entities. Chinese "queer" has also reported an intimacy with the Chinese sociologist Li Yinhe, who introduced the queer theory into China (Li 2003; Zhao and Wong 2020); whereas the English "queer" is otherwise related to the American-Taiwanese queer artist Skyler Chen.

Plot 1: Key PERSONS and GRE Entities of Queer



The results of Named Entity Recognition (NER) show that, within the Chinese context, the term

"queer" is no longer confined to the Western context, but is deeply associated with Chinese or Asian context. Despite specific persons being related to the Chinese and English word "queer" may vary slightly, all of them come from an academic or artistic background may also suggest certain patterns here. The geographical location highlights the word "queer" has been positioned into the dualities between "Western vs. Asia", or "the United States vs. China", while at the same time other global locations are insignificant or neglected.

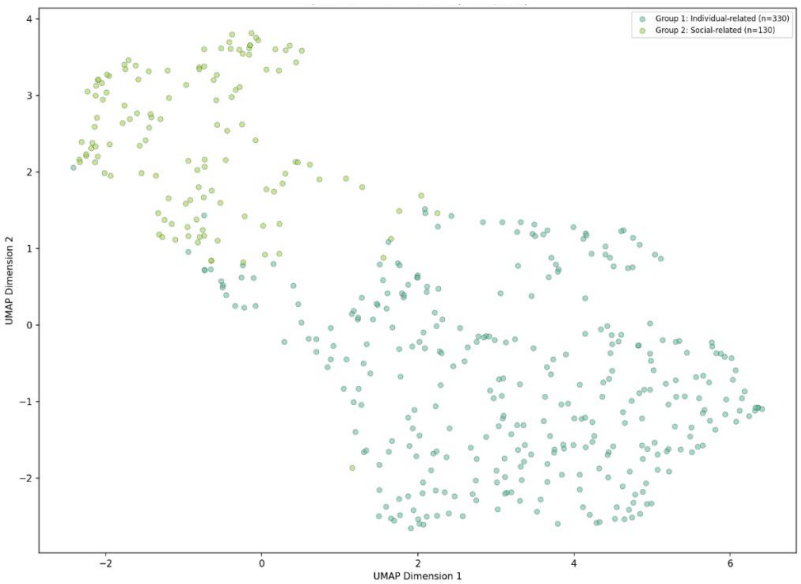
The results of NER in this corpus also have limitations. Because my textual dataset is a random selection in April 2026, for example, a high relevance between "queer" and "Cocona" may not be a regular occurrence but rather as a temporary result of recent social news. I manually checked these related posts and found that RedNote's users were discussing Cocona's queer identity, when they came out as transmasculine non-binary person from an original Japanese female idol group in December 2025.

Contextual Meaning with BERT

In order to further understand the social meaning of the word "queer" in the Chinese context, I employ the BERT contextual word embedding to cluster meaning groups and then identify these meanings through inspecting their TF-IDF distinctive words. I conduct three-level clustering: document-level, word-level, and subgroup-level.

The results of document-level clustering explore the related topics of "queer" across these 460 RedNote posts. The results of the silhouette curve suggests these 460 documents are optimal to be divided into two topical groups (see Plot 2). TF-IDF top terms can exhibit the most related word to word "queer" in the same document context. Through comparing the top 5 TF-IDF keywords of document groups 1 and 2, results suggest Chinese people may daily mention the word "queer" under two main topics: one is more individual-level and about identity and subjectivity, while the other is more socially connected with social activism and the public knowledge system. The top five distinctive TF-IDF terms of Group 1 "individual-level" are "relationship"[关系], "culture"[文化], "identity"[身份], "society"[社会], "self"[自我], while of the Group 2 "social-level" are "permission"[许可], "sociology" [社会学], "gender study" [性别研究], "short film" [短片], "Butler"[巴特勒] .

Plot 2 Document-level Embedding Clusters: social and individual (k=2)



Then I employ the word-level contextual embedding to cluster the potential meaning group to understand the exact semantic meaning of the word "queer" in the real Chinese everyday online

discussion. Focusing on the word "queer" across documents specifically, the results of the word-level embedding have been presented in Plot 2. The word-level clustering of "queer" and its variants are also optimal to constitute two distinctive meaning groups. However, by conducting a cross-tabulation analysis to examine the relationship between two document themes and two meaning groups, this study finds that the two usages of "queer" are not distinguished by the document groups (see Table 3). Instead, through manually inspecting the top distinctive TF-IDF terms of each meaning group and its sample sentences, I found two clusters are divided by language. Many top TF-IDF terms in meaning group 1 are English whereas in meaning group 2 are Chinese. There are two potential explanations for this linguistic division. On one hand, it may suggest the English and Chinese "queer" have evolved to separate from each other and represent different semantic meanings. Or, on the other hand, it could also be a dangerous warning that this BERT model fails to divide semantic meaning groups but simply categorizes them by language.

Plot 3 Word-level Embedding Clusters: English and Chinese (k=2)

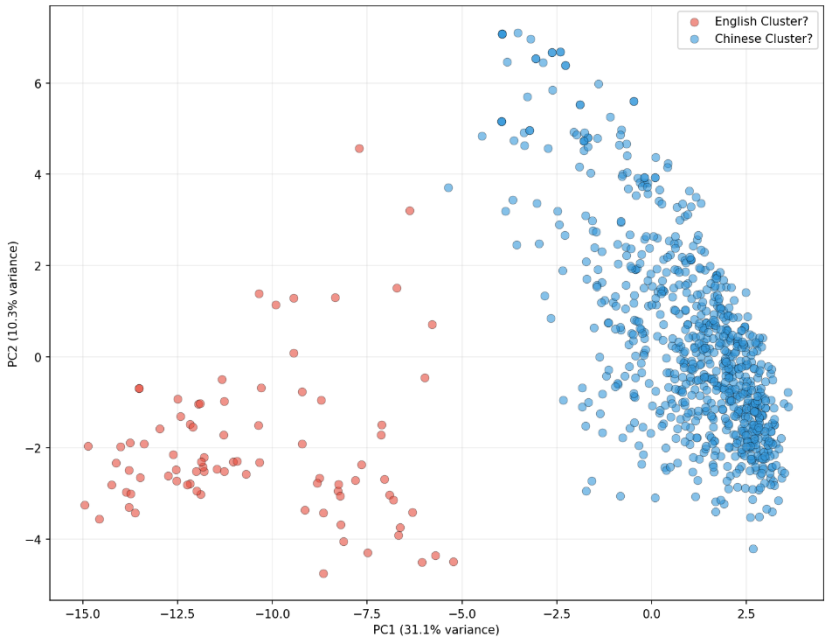


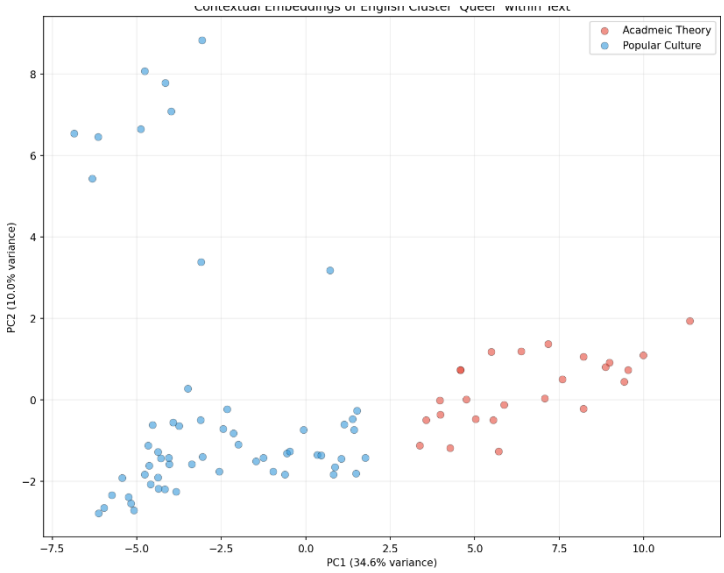
Table 3 Cross-Tabulation: Document x Word

Document x Word	English Cluster (?)	Chinese Cluster (?)	Total
Individual-related	65	700	765
Social-related	19	80	99
Total	84	780	864

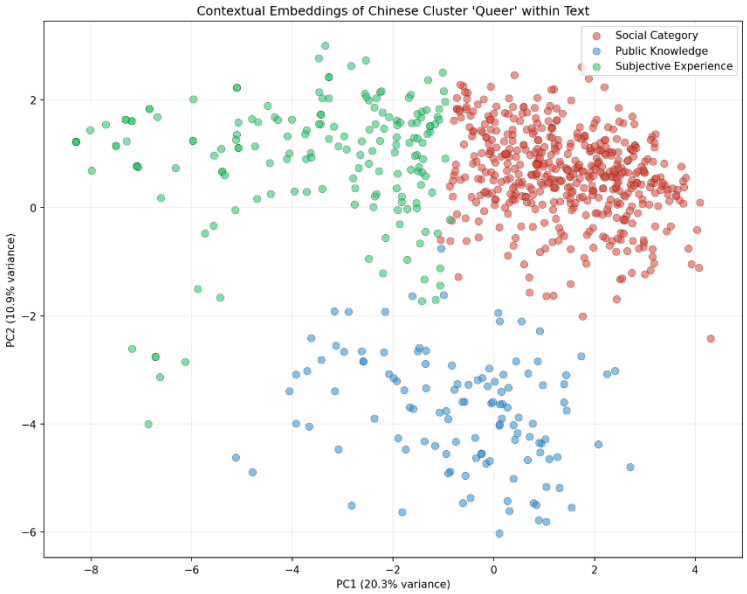
In order to check whether the BERT model is working properly and further understand the specific semantic meaning of the word "queer" within each linguistic clusters, I separate the English and Chinese clusters that are generated by the word-level BERT model and then re-conduct the BERT clustering and the TF-IDF top word interpretation of each subgroup. I found the "English Clusters" can be further divided into two meaning groups while each separately suggest a close connection with "popular culture and "academic theory" (see Plot 4); The "Chinese Clusters" can be further divided into three meaning groups and be relevant to the "social category", "public knowledge", and "subjective experience" respectively (see Plot 5). The results of the subgroup contextual embedding may clarify the previous results of the "Chinese vs. English" dichotomy and suggest the word "queer" has been evolved into

participating in diverse and complex discussions on Chinese social media. When using in its English form, “queer” is related to popular culture and academic theory; when using in its Chinese form “ku’er”[酷儿], it is related to an even border personal experiences, social category or a cultural token. These nuanced linguistic usage may suggest a complex diversification as well as localization of the concept “queer” within the Chinese context..

Plot 4 Subgroup Embedding of the English Cluster (k=2)



Plot 5 Subgroup Embedding of the Chinese Cluster (k=3)



Supervised Classification (Logistic Regression)

To verify the classifications in contextual embeddings, I randomly generate trainset from Chinese cluster and English cluster as the weak labels and then use logistic regression to train classifiers respectively. My goal is to evaluate whether the results in BERT subgroup clustering are significant or not, and whether the Logistic Regression can identify and distinguish these different semantic meanings correctly and clearly.

In the English cluster, I train a Logistic Regression to distinguish between queer as an academic

concept in “academic theory” and as a cultural token in “popular culture”. Given the limited total sample size in the English cluster and the imbalance in sample counts (“academic theory” includes 25 samples and “popular culture” includes 59 samples), I randomly select 12 samples from each group as the weak labels to form the trainset. I employ the L2 Ridge Regression in machine learning and receive the classifier results in Table 4. Results show the classifier reaches a strong overall performance and ability to distinguish the two semantic groups within the English cluster. The high F1-score of 0.97 and a ROC AUC of 1.0 indicate this model’s high accuracy and ability to distinguish “academic theory” and “popular culture” two classes.

Table 4 Logistic Regression (L2) for distinguishing semantic groups within the English cluster

```
Label 0 -> Acadmeic Theory
Label 1 -> Popular Culture

Train size: 24
Test size: 60
Confusion matrix:
[[13  0]
 [ 2 45]]

Classification report:
                 precision    recall  f1-score   support

Acadmeic Theory       0.87      1.00      0.93        13
Popular Culture       1.00      0.96      0.98        47

       accuracy                           0.97        60
      macro avg       0.93      0.98      0.95        60
   weighted avg       0.97      0.97      0.97        60

ROC AUC: 1.0
Non-zero coefficients: 768 / 768
Sparsity (fraction non-zero): 1.0000
```

In the Chinese cluster, I similarly train a Logistic Regression (L2) to verify whether the model can significantly distinguish queer as a “social category”, as a part of “public knowledge” or as an identity/identification in their “subjective experience”. I random select 70 samples from each class as

Table 5 Logistic Regression (L2) for distinguishing semantic groups within the Chinese cluster

```
Label 0 -> Public Knowledge
Label 1 -> Social Category
Label 2 -> Subjective Experience

Train size: 210
Test size: 570
Confusion matrix:
[[ 50   0   0]
 [  2 398  14]
 [  0   1 105]]

Classification report:
                      precision    recall  f1-score   support

     Public Knowledge       0.96      1.00      0.98        50
      Social Category       1.00      0.96      0.98       414
Subjective Experience       0.88      0.99      0.93       106

             accuracy                           0.97       570
            macro avg       0.95      0.98      0.96       570
         weighted avg       0.97      0.97      0.97       570

Non-zero coefficients: 2304 / 2304
Sparsity: 1.0000
```

the weak labels to form a trainset and successfully train a model showing results in Table 5. The high F1-score of 0.97 suggest this model's high accuracy and strong ability to distinguish "public knowledge", "social category" and "subjective experience" three classes. Although the results in the Confusion Although the matrix may suggest that the model exhibits some overlap errors when distinguishing between "social categories" and "subjective experiences," the overall accuracy across these three categories indicates that this distinction is mostly accurate and reliable.

The results of the Logistic Regression showcases the meaning group clustering by the BERT model are significant and reliable. Chinese and English "queer" clusters are not only different as a result of their linguistic form but also because of their different semantic meanings in usage.

5. Discussions and Conclusion: the Duality/Diversity of Chinese "Queer"

Queer in the Chinese context has begun its localization and been intertwined with the specific local context. After importing into the Chinese context, the results of NER suggest that "China", "Asia" and "East Asia" have shifted to be the new top geographical location where queer are positioning; Asian scholars and artists, such as Li Yinhe or Skyler Chen, have also become the new key figures in addition to the Western figure Judith Butler or Michel Foucault. In addition to the increase of Chinese/Asian key entities, the results of document-level contextual embedding also suggest the word "queer" has now been used in various online discussions. I argue that these results have suggested the word queer may exhibit contextual dualities between the individual level and social level, and between academia and social activism. This is probably related to its terminological origin. In its original Western English context, the way people today view "queer" as a self-affirmative social category is strongly related to AIDS social activism and the recent academic trend toward "queer theory" after the 1980s and 1990s (Epstein 1994). When it has been imported into the Chinese context, it's also related to academia and social activism, respectively (Zhao and Wong 2020).

However, according to the results of word-level cluster embedding (Plot 3-5) and the Cross-Tabulation table (Table 3), what complicates this contextual duality is the word-level meaning duality: the word "queer" itself is not divided into dual meaning groups by its dual contexts, but rather by language. Previous scholars often warn that the spread of Western categories, such as the growing ubiquity of the word "queer" in the global LGBTQ community, is bringing a universalization that may homogenize the diverse gender and sexuality culture across contexts (Sinnott 2010; Dutta and Roy 2014; Savci 2020). The actual division between the English form "queer" and its Chinese transliteration "ku'er"[酷儿] in this study probably responds to that anxiety through highlighting that translation is not a replication but a reproduction of semantic meaning and contextual usage. Similar to what Wilson (2006) has reminded us, cross-cultural usage of Western categories does not necessarily mean a universalization, but a terminological reproduction and a new social category: Chinese people use the English form "queer" and the Chinese transliteration "ku'er" [酷儿] to imply different semantic meanings within different contexts. For example, in contrast to the English form "queer", which is often used to introduce the popular culture or academic theory, the Chinese form "ku'er"[酷儿] has been involved into more diverse local contents from social categories, public knowledge to subjective experience (see Plot 5).

Under the same name to be called as "queer" or "ku'er" [酷儿], this study argues that, the spread of queer may not necessarily suggest a so-called "universalization" to eliminate local queer culture like some scholars are concerned. Instead, it rather showcases a localization or reintegration of using the

"imported" or "externally-borrowed" transnational social category to enrich local ways to express feelings and experiences. "Queer" was once a Western social category, and it has now become a discursive localized category across different cultures and regions, suggesting its potential emergence as a transnational social category.

Overall, through employing NER, BERT word embedding model and Logistic Regression to verify the clusters, this study discusses the cross-cultural usage of the word "queer" in the Chinese context. In the Chinese context, the word "queer" also exhibits a nuanced but complex linguistic duality and diversity. The word "queer" is used bilingually (see Plot 3) and positioned into a contextual duality between the Western and China (see Plot 1) and individual experience and social experiences (see Plot 2). Meanwhile, it has also exhibited the diversity of its semantic meanings, which ranged from popular culture, academic theory, social category, public knowledge to subjective experience (see Plot 4-5). In the Chinese context, queer is no longer refined as a Western imported concept but has become deeply involved in the Chinese/Asia context. This study may build a conversation with current scholarly discussions on the universalization of gender culture, and shed light on the localization of the emerging transnational social category. From the method dimension, this study also shows that NLP techniques have the potential to help scholars capture the synchronic diversity of semantic meanings and the most nuanced linguistic difference. For example, the division between Chinese "ku'er"[酷儿] and English "queer" may be hard to notice and separate in traditional qualitative studies.

However, this study also has some limitations that need to be highlighted again. One of the most fatal limitations is the small number of samples. Future study should consider to examine results in a larger and more comprehensive dataset. Because sometimes feminist-related and queer-related topics in China are regarded as politically sensitive, scholars should also evaluate the potential impact of censorship when engaging with any dataset related to queer or feminist content on social media. If future studies can get access to some larger and more comprehensive datasets, one direction for future research is to examine the diachronic evolution of "queer" and "ku'er"[酷儿], two terms in the Chinese context over the past 30 years. How are these two terms gradually separated and differentiated? Another direction is to examine the relationship between individuals and categories, for example, by analyzing how various demographic characteristics (e.g., gender, sexuality, age, class, or educational background) may shape people's acceptance and usage of "queer" or "ku'er" [酷儿].

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■ ***Queer Materials***

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